

CHOC-A-BLOC Traffic jam on a road leading to the Yelahanka IAF station, Bengaluru, in February



"BENGALURU CAN'T BE CHANGED IN 2-3 YEARS. EVEN GOD CAN'T DO THAT. IT CAN BE CHANGED ONLY WHEN PROPER PLANS ARE MADE AND EXECUTED WELL"

D.K. SHIVAKUMAR
Deputy CM, Karnataka

room created by the state's 7.4 per cent growth in GSDP in FY25, and prioritise capital expenditure. The government is bullish on Bengaluru, with the CM doubling the infrastructure allocation for the city to Rs 12,500 crore, from Rs 6,500 crore in FY25.

FIXING BENGALURU

The scale of the problem isn't small because Bengaluru's woes have compounded over the years. To begin with, the city has been without a masterplan since the previous one lapsed in 2015. Contributing to this is a vexing reality: civic amenities, ranging from roads, water supply, electricity, bus and metro services, are managed by a multitude of autonomous agencies, or parastatals, which work in silos. Shivakumar, in fact, openly declared at a recent public event: "Bengaluru can't be changed in 2-3 years. Even God can't do that. It can be changed only when proper plans are made and executed well."

To address Bengaluru's woes, the deputy CM piloted the Greater Bengaluru Governance Bill (GBG), 2024 on March 10. The bill proposes a tiered governance system for the city, splitting the existing civic authority, the Bruhat Bengaluru Mahanagara Palike (BBMP), into smaller corporations. Overseeing these entities will be the Greater Bengaluru Authority, which will serve as the city's planning body. It will bring together all the parastatals onto a single platform, and the chief minister will be its ex-officio chairman. "We need a platform where each agency talks to each other and there is coordination," says Congress MLA Rizwan